

The Purification of Offerings

Dakṣiṇī Parīśodhanī Nāma · Toh 777 · Derge Kangyur

ཡའོ་ཡངས་ས་སྤྱོད་བཞེས་བུའ་གི་ཟདས།

The Purification of Offerings (Sanskrit Dakṣiṇī Pariśodhanī Nāma, Tibetan Yon yongs su sbyong ba, though the Tibetan title line is only partly legible in the source) is a short dhāraṇī text concerned with purifying the gifts and offerings made to the saṅgha and other recipients, so that the giver's merit is made complete and unobstructed. It opens with homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas, to the Tathāgata King of Light Shining Everywhere, and to Mañjuśrī in his form as a youthful prince, and then presents the mantra itself, whose invocation addresses the one who is free of all support and appearance, victorious and wise. The text promises that whoever recites it will be freed from all illnesses and harmful spirits and will not give an opening to hostile forces, benefits typical of the protective dhāraṇī genre. It is Toh 777 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section, among the many brief dhāraṇīs and ritual protection texts preserved there.

...will not find an opening. One will be freed from all illnesses and harmful spirits. The dhāraṇī of circumambulation is complete.

In the Indian language: Dakṣiṇī Pariśodhanī Nāma. In the Tibetan language:
The Purification of Offerings.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas. Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, the King of Light Shining Everywhere. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, endowed with great compassion and endowed with intelligence, Mañjuśrī who has become a youthful prince.

Namaḥ Samanta Prabha Rājāya, Tathāgatāya, Arhate Bhyaḥ,
Samyaksambuddhāya. Namo Mañjuśrīye, Kumārabhūtāya, Bodhisattvāya,
Mahāsattvāya, Mahākāraṇikāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ Nirālambe, Nirābhāse, Jaye
Jayalabdhe, Mahāmate Dakṣe Dikṣaṇī Paṛśodhāya Svāhā.

By reciting this just once, all negative deeds are purified. Even offerings that have been misused or squandered are purified. The benefactor's offerings will increase, and all accumulations will be completed. By reciting this, no obstacles of any kind will arise.

This is drawn from the Sūtra of the Detailed Determination of the Vinaya Scripture, the offering...

Translator's Notes

- The passage begins mid-text, with the end of the preceding dhāraṇī, and breaks off mid-title at the end, so the final sentence is incomplete. The Sanskrit title is transmitted as Dakṣiṇī Pariśodhanī, while the mantra spells the word Dikṣaṇī, a corruption typical of transliterated Tibetan mantra texts. I rendered the mantra in conventional Sanskrit transliteration without translating it. The Tibetan ཡོན་ (yon) means gifts or offerings made to the Saṅgha or a benefactor, the Sanskrit dakṣiṇā. The phrase "offerings that have been misused or squandered" renders "offerings that were put to many uses," which refers to the misuse of such gifts. The source title at the end is the Vinaya-viniścaya-sūtra, which I rendered as "Detailed Determination of the Vinaya Scripture."

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.